

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

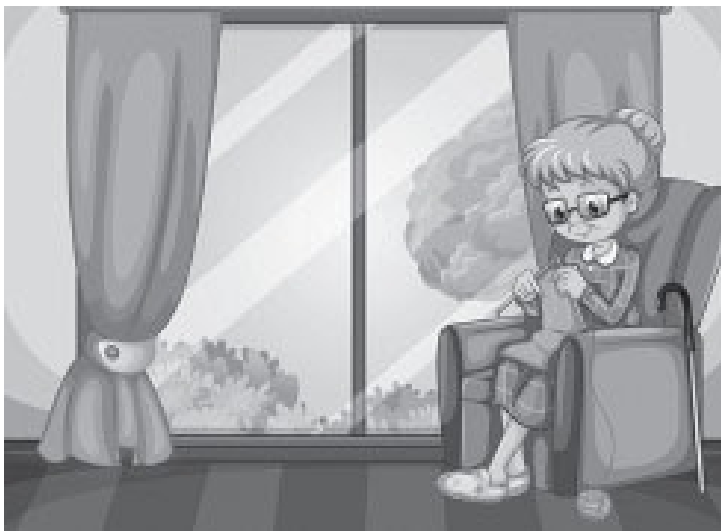
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Let's Start!

We learn from our elders.



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you spent much time with your grandparents?
- Do you remember things they used to tell you?
- What experiences have you had together?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about family life.
- I can talk about people's past habits.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.





Let's Explore!

Peter is reminded of experiences he had with his grandfather.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Oh, this bridge reminds me of my childhood. My grandfather used to take me on walks across this bridge. We would each throw one small stone into the river.
- Sally:** My father used to take me to the park, but I haven't spent much time with my grandparents. They used to visit Cambridge only on holiday weekends.
- Peter:** My grandparents were newcomers to the U.S. They came to the U.S. soon after they were married. They have worked hard since then to establish a good life for their family.
- Sally:** You told me that your grandfather wanted you to learn the history of the country.
- Peter:** He used to tell me, "If you know where this country has come from, you can play a strong role in where it's going." He has read me stories about the American Revolution since I was a kid. We would go to the library once a week, and he would help me pick out a book.
- Sally:** So, you used to read a lot in your free time and watch baseball games on TV?
- Peter:** Yeah! And I ran around outside.
- Sally:** Well, I certainly learned a lot about Boston's history from you.



Let's Practice!

Memories of family time are sweet.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing words. Find the missing words in the wordsearch.

Words

1. This building reminds me my _____.
2. They used to come to Cambridge only on holiday _____.
3. They worked pretty hard to establish a good _____ for their _____.
4. He read stories about the American _____.

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B	X	U	V	Y	O	C	U	F	O	P	N	P	L	O	T	Y	N
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C	J	O	C	Y	V	G	I	J	O	I	U	H	P	U	L	O	Y



Let's Practice!

Newcomers work hard to be part of their new homeland.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below. Circle the incorrect words. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. My grandparents have work hard to establish a good life for their family.
2. I think your grandparents have succeed it.
3. I haven't spend much time with my grandparents.
4. My grandfather has red me stories about the American Revolution since I was a kid.
5. Well, I've certainly yearned a lot about Boston's history from you.





Extension Activity

Let's talk about past experiences with our family.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Create a dialogue of 10 lines with your partner about a childhood experience each of you has had with a grandparent or parent.
- Talk about the experience in detail. Use the Present Perfect tense.
- Talk about what you used to do or any routine you had together.
- Practice the dialogue several times aloud with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about a childhood experience.

☐
☐

I apply the proper action words about a past experience.

☐
☐

I express past habits or routine.

☐
☐

I practice the dialogue with my partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **childhood** (noun): the period of time when a person is a child
e.g. He felt this bridge reminds him of his childhood.
- **to remind** (verb): to make someone think about something again
e.g. The bridge reminded the man of his own childhood.
- **to establish** (verb): to begin or create something that is meant to last for a long time
e.g. His grandparents worked hard to establish a good life for their family.
- **kid** (noun): a young person; informal word for "child"
e.g. He remembers good times when he was a kid.
- **to play a role** (expression): to take or play an active part in something
e.g. The boy was told to play a role in where his country is heading.
- **to run around** (verb): to run from one place to another playfully with no particular purpose.
e.g. He use to run around outside a lot as a kid.





Learning Points

Since When?

You use the preposition **for** with a period of time, for example: a few days, half an hour, two years.

You use the preposition **since** with the time when the action started, for example: *Last year, June 8, I met you.*

Examples:

- *They have worked hard **since** then to establish a good life for their family.*
- *He has read stories about the American Revolution **since** I was a kid.*
- *I have read at night **for** 6 years.*





Learning Points

Used to and Would for Past Habits

You use *used to* to express a past action and/or a state.

Examples:

When I was a child, my father used to take me on walks across this bridge. (action)

We used to live in Cambridge. (state)

Notice that in the negative and the question forms you do not use the *d*.

Examples:

Which park did you use to go?

My mother didn't use to read a lot of stories.

You cannot use *used to* with a time reference + a number.

Incorrect:

I used to spend time with my grandparents in Cambridge for 5 years.

Correct:

I used to spend time with my grandparents in Cambridge every day.

When you express a series of past actions, you start with *used to*, then continue with *would*.

Example:

When I was a child, we used to walk in the park. We would play there, and we would throw one small stone into the river.

Would is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while *used to* does not require this.

Used to	Would
<i>My grandfather used to take me on walks across this bridge.</i>	<i>We would each throw one small stone into the river.</i>
<i>He has read me stories since I was a kid.</i>	<i>We would go to the library once a week.</i>